Colour frequency and phototherapy

With white people talk about "white light" and a "higher frequency". It sounds as if it had its own number that could be read off. A white wall does not **produce** light, it only **reflects** part of the incoming light. Let us say what of this is **atmosphere** and what is already **treatment**.

And it is just here that it is good to leave aside **miraculous promises**. A white wall or a white lamp is not in itself a therapeutic light method.

There is no single white "photon number"

A white impression arises from a combination of light components. Different sources can look white, yet their spectral composition differs. A warm-white and a cool-white lamp can also create a different impression. Besides the shade, the intensity, the direction of the light and the time of day matter.

What bright light treatment is for

Bright light treatment is used, for example, for winter seasonal depression. Here it is no longer about a symbol of purity, but about the effect of light on systems linked with the daily rhythm and mood. Designated devices and a specific procedure are used. A room painted white is no substitute for them.

If you are considering this therapy because of marked seasonal difficulties, discuss suitability with a doctor. Your health, certain medicines and possible eye disease also matter.

What of this belongs in an ordinary day

Notice how much daylight you actually get. If you spend the day in dimness and sit in the evening under very bright lighting, **choosing a white colour for the room alone will not solve it**.

When it is pleasant to switch off

Dimness can help create a restful atmosphere. For some more darkness is pleasant, others need a guide light. You don't need to learn to love light for your work with colours to be right.

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